

to on your “keyring”, you can use your mail client to send it to that location. If you don’t have the public key, you can ask the person to mail it to you, or you can just search for it on the hundreds of public key servers available online.

Once you have the key, you get onto your e-mail client, type in your message and select “Encrypt” (or “Confidential”) from the PGP menu. The program will ask you for your passphrase, and will encrypt your message. For the receiver to read the message, he will have to choose “Decrypt” (or “Verify”) from the PGP menu and then, key in his passphrase.

6.5.3 Hushmail

An alternative to PGP is a service called Hushmail (www.hushmail.com). It is similar to standard free e-mail services. However, Hushmail offers a high level of security given its encryption. The best part about Hushmail is that you can use it from anywhere, that is, like Gmail and the others, you can sign in from any computer connected to the Internet. All you need to know is your private/secret key.